



Records of the World Cube Association in Europe

About World Cube Association (WCA)

The WCA governs competitions for mechanical puzzles that are operated by twisting groups of pieces, commonly known as 'twisty puzzles'.

The most famous of these puzzles is the Rubik's Cube, invented by professor Rubik from Hungary. A selection of these puzzles is chosen as official events of the WCA.

The World Cube Association has had over 245,000 unique competitors across 158 different regions.

Each weekend about 70 competitions are held and once in 2 years a World Championship is hosted, where top 'cubers' from around the world are competing for the World Champion title.

WCA competition rules

Competitors need to bring their own puzzle that doesn't violate any rules. Their puzzle will be scrambled into a pre-generated combination by other competitors.

For most of the events, competitors are allowed to think about their first move during a 15 second inspection time after their scrambled puzzle has been revealed. Afterwards, whenever the competitor raises his hands from the specified area, the timer starts. They solve their puzzle and the timer stops again when their hands return to the area.

People compete in best single and best average category. In most events, best average is calculated from 5 different solves with the best and worst time excluded. Other alternatives are mean of 3 or number of Rubik's cubes solved while blindfolded in one run.

Rubik's cube (3x3x3) is the oldest and the most prestigious competition event. It was introduced at the first World Competition in 1982 in Budapest as the only event. The best people today are able to solve it in around 6 seconds with the best official solve being 2.76 seconds by Teodor Zajder from Poland. The other listed events were introduced in official competitions in 2003 and 2004.

Instead of the regular 15 seconds for inspecting the cube, the competitors get as much time as they need, after which they are blindfolded, and perform the solve relying solely on their memory. Fastest time of 11.67 seconds is now being held by Charlie Egghins.

Megaminx

This puzzle is dodecahedral in shape (12 sides), and has a total of 50 movable pieces to rearrange; the original Rubik's Cube only has 20. Despite the daunting size and shape of the "cube", its solving strategy is very similar to that of a normal Rubik's Cube. The fastest official solve time is 21.85 seconds achieved by Timofei Tarasenko from Russia.

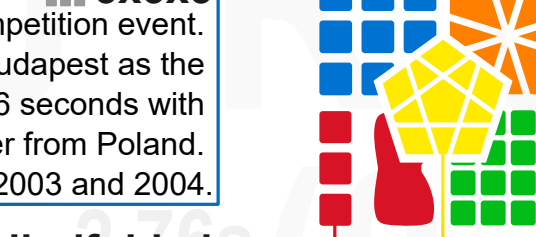
About poster

This poster was not made by the WCA, it is only showing results of competitions hosted by the WCA in Europe. The WCA logo is used for illustrative purposes only.

Data for the main map (Best world rank and number of people in top 1000) are taken from the Best Single competing category.

Each symbol represents 5 competing events

3x3x3



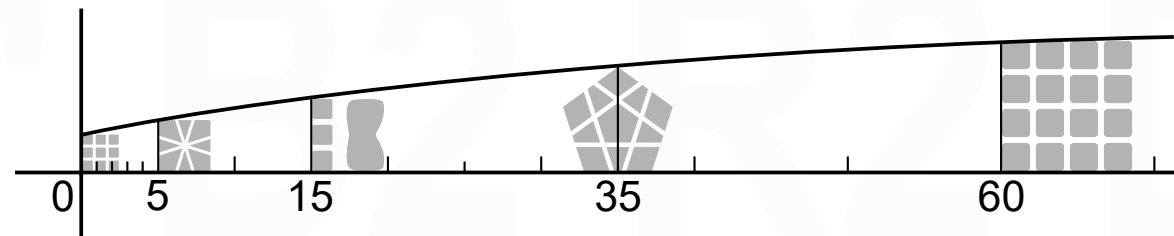
Square-1

By its size and count of pieces, it is very similar to the original Rubik's cube, but this puzzle's shape is changeable throughout the solve, making it arguably the hardest official puzzle to learn. It has three layers of pieces, which are shaped like triangular prisms pointing to the centre of the cube. The world record of 3.40 seconds is held by American Hassan Khanani.

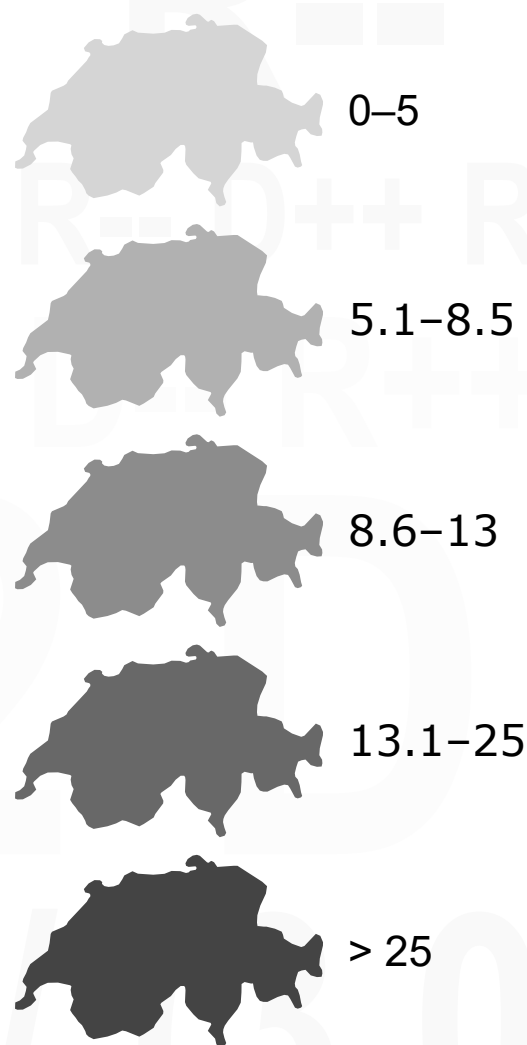
4x4x4

Very similar to 3x3x3, this event adds 1 more piece to each dimension of the cube, making it 4x4x4. That size difference increases the complexity, and prolongs the solve times of the puzzle. The world record is 11.67 seconds achieved by Tymon Kolasiński from Poland.

Number of people in top 1000



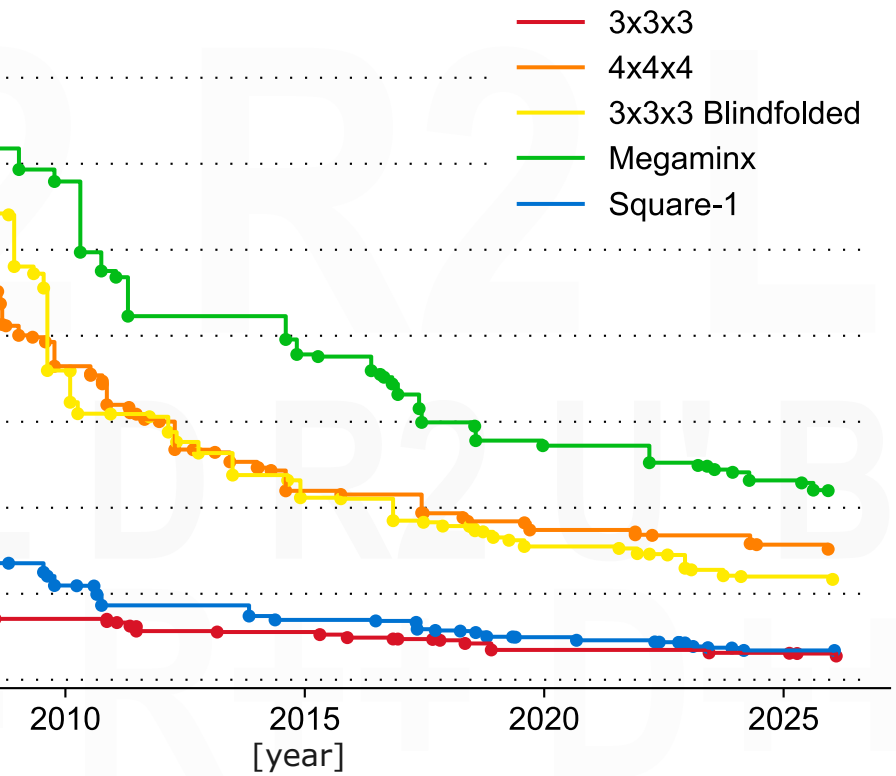
Number of WCA competitors per 100,000 people



Best world rank



Evolution of solve times

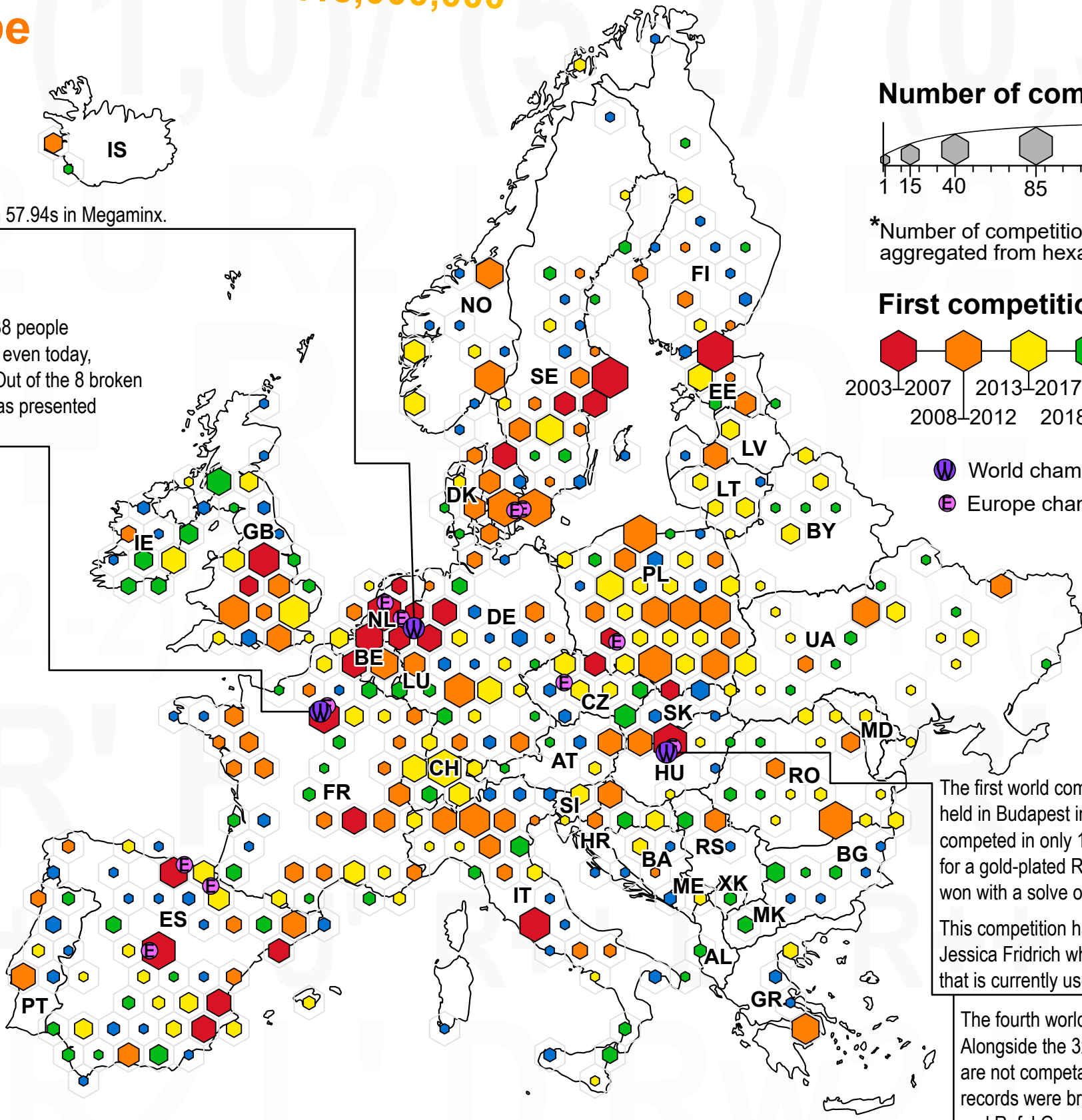


WCA competitions across Europe

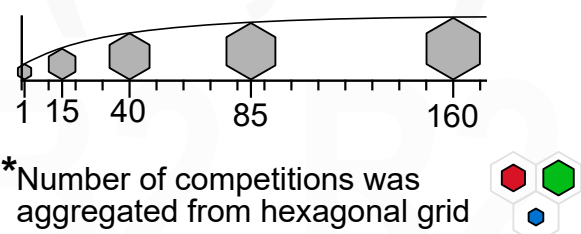
The fifth world championship took place in Düsseldorf in 2009. It featured 19 events, with new addition of 6x6x6 and 7x7x7 cubes. Breandan Vallance secured the world champion title with an average 3x3x3 solve of 10.74s. Another 4 world records were broken, e.g. Piotr Michal Padlewski with 10.96s in Square-1 and Bálint Bodor with 57.94s in Megaminx.

The ninth world championship took place in Paris in 2017. Overall 938 people competed across 18 events. Max Park, one of the best speedcubers even today, won the world champion title with an average 3x3x3 solve of 6.85s. Out of the 8 broken world records, Feliks Zemdegs is responsible for 6 of them, Feliks was presented as the best cuber in the world at that time.

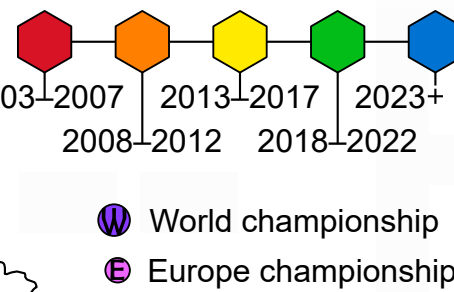
- | | | | |
|----|------------------------|----|--------------------|
| AL | Albania | IT | Italy |
| AT | Austria | LT | Lithuania |
| BA | Bosnia and Herzegovina | LU | Luxembourg |
| BE | Belgium | LV | Latvia |
| BG | Bulgaria | MD | Moldova |
| BY | Belarus | ME | Montenegro |
| CH | Switzerland | MK | North Macedonia |
| CY | Cyprus | NL | Netherlands |
| CZ | Czechia | NO | Norway |
| DE | Germany | PL | Poland |
| DK | Denmark | PT | Portugal |
| EE | Estonia | RO | Romania |
| ES | Spain | RS | Serbia |
| FI | Finland | RU | Russian Federation |
| FR | France | SE | Sweden |
| GB | United Kingdom | SI | Slovenia |
| GR | Greece | SK | Slovakia |
| HR | Croatia | TR | Turkey |
| HU | Hungary | UA | Ukraine |
| IE | Ireland | XK | Kosovo |
| IS | Iceland | | |



Number of competitions*



First competition held



The first world competition was held in Budapest in 1982. 19 people competed in only 1 event, 3x3x3, for a gold-plated Rubik's cube. Minh Thai won with a solve of 22.95 seconds.

This competition had a Czech competitor Jessica Fridrich who invented the CFOP method, that is currently used by the majority of cubers worldwide.

The fourth world competition was held again in Budapest in 2007. Alongside the 3x3x3 it featured another 17 events, some of which are not competitive today (3x3x3 with feet, magic). Overall 7 world records were broken, e.g. Lukasz Cialon with 3.91s average in 2x2x2 and Rafal Guzowicz solved 6 Rubik's cubes while blindfolded.

Competition-based cuber migration in Europe

